The pioneer of India for heart valve replacements without open heart surgery namely TAVI/ TAVR introduced 4 of the world's first heart treatments and 18 of India's first heart treatments. He obtained a Guinness World Record for India in the field of TAVI.



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Heart diseases continue to be the leading cause of death in India and worldwide. As a result, treatments for heart diseases are growing exponentially and have led to increasingly minimally invasive treatments thereby minimising hospital stay for patients and improving quality of life for heart patients. Dr A B Gopalamurugan is a pioneer of such heart treatments without open heart surgery and has been awarded "The Most Pioneering and Sought After cardiologist of India" by 'The Times of India' in 2022.

HEART VALVE REPLACEMENTS WITHOUT SURGERY -TAVI OR TAVR

TAVI/TAVR stands for Transcatheter Aortic Valve Implantation/Replacement which means replacing the heart valve (Aortic Valve) without open heart surgery, often performed without anesthesia too. The first TAVR in India with Evolut valve was done in 2015 when Dr Gopalamurugan returned back from UK to set up such advanced treatments in India. At that time, there were no TAVR/TAVI treatments in India. Once he performed that first successful procedure in 2015 on compassionate grounds, TAVI treatments became officially commercialised in India in 2016. Therefore, to date, the longest living TAVI/TAVR patient in India is only 8 years and that patient is indeed the first TAVI performed by Dr Gopalamurugan in 2015. The other most important valve in the heart is the Mitral valve. The mitral valve is even more complex structure than the aortic valve. Dr A B Gopalamurugan is the pioneer in the world for Transcatheter Mitral Valve Replacement (TMVR) when he demonstrated in 2011 to the entire world on how the mitral valve can be replaced without open heart surgery. This raised eyebrows across the world and his new treatment was published in the world's leading heart journal namely Journal of American College of Cardiology (JACC). Hundreds of thousands of patients are benefitted across the world as a result. Once he moved to India and performed the first successful TAVI in India in 2015 (with Evolut valve) he performed Indio's first TMVR in 2017 whereby a patient's mitral valve in India was replaced without conventional open heart surgery. Therefore, the longest living patient in India to date who has had a TMVR is only 6 years. The longest living TAVI patient and TMVR patient today are doing well and live in Chennai. Dr Gopalamurugan did not stop there. He went on to perform India's first Tricuspid Valve Replacement (TTVR) without open heart surgery in 2017and subsequently introduced the maximum number of heart valve replacement techniques without open heart surgery to India. As a result of such cutting edge treatments introduced to India, thousands of patients have benefitted to date and he performs the largest number of such treatments in the country

HEART BLOOD VESSEL TREATMENTS WITHOUT BYPASS SURGERY - LASER ANGIOPLASTY

He is currently one of the most highly rated cardiologists in India according to a google survey because of his wholistic and cutting edge treatment delivery with the best outcomes. Patients form across India and abroad come to avail his services for heart treatments. Dr A B Gopalamurugan performed India's first commercial Laser angioplasty after government approval in January 202. This technology opened possibilities for many patients who otherwise would have to under open heart surgery. As a result of his expertise, today he performs one of the largest number of laser angioplasties in India thereby treating hundreds of patients every year who were planned or open heart surgery. These patients have their blood vessels opened without open heart surgery and walk home the next day. This has made a difference to thousands of patients across the country.

SECRET OF SUCCESS

When asked about the secret of his success and how he is so passionate on patient care and outcomes, he replied "what I will do for my father or mother is what I do for every single patient who walks up to my office, and that's what I have done thus far too, so therefore I don't think of anything less than the best in the world for my patients". He has a unique model of working whereby he is not employed by any corporate hospital. "I feel not being employed by any organisation allows me to work without any pressures putting patient's wellbeing at the forefront of whatever I do, it also allows me to think outside the box and dedicate time towards coming up with novel treatment options for my patients", said Dr Gopalamurugan when we questioned him on why he is not employed. He also added "But I can only deliver high quality treatments when I have world class facilities. Therefore, I am associated with organisations that provide such world class facilities and support which are patient centred. My primary hospital where I operate for all my patients is MGM Hospital, Chennai where I have every facility possible in the world". Dr ABG said his guru and inspiration was his father late Dr K Bhimaraja who taught him the principles of good patient care.